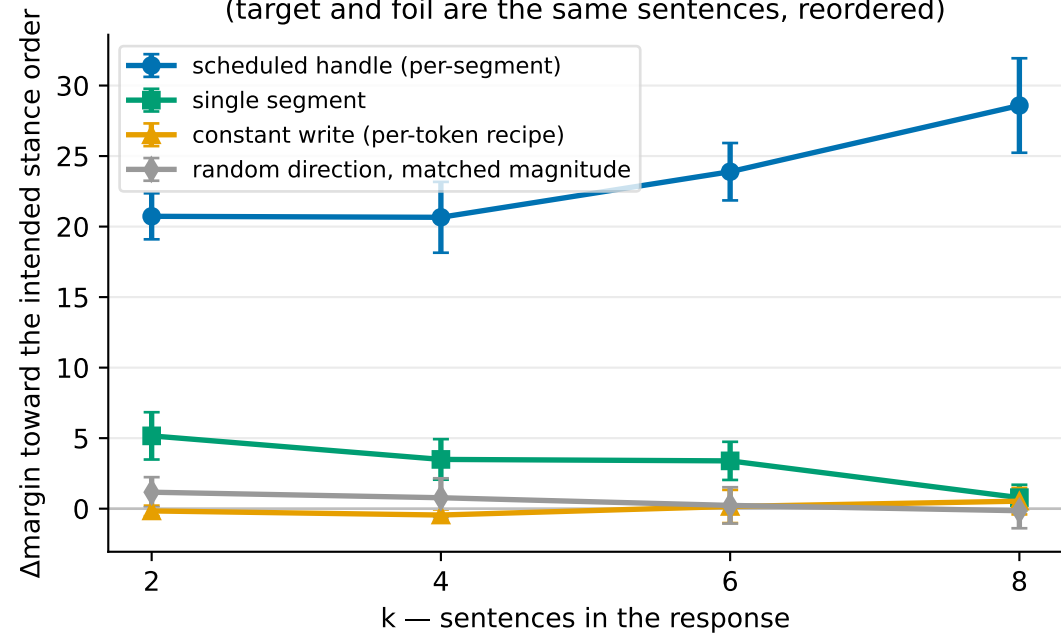


Staged refusal: a safety-relevant behaviour whose useful control is a schedule, not a level (Qwen-2.5-1.5B, L14)

A. Steering the refuse/comply order within one response
(target and foil are the same sentences, reordered)



B. Behavioural check: does the model's own choice follow?
(held-out candidates, model's intrinsic preference differenced out)

